someone who was certainly not secular—deep religious portrayal was the virtue of his place and his time.

Finally, I decided to write books on history about those whom we wrongly call Moghūls.

The job was certainly no cakewalk and sought abundant efforts including the translations of original manuscripts in Persian to verify the translations already available. I had set my intent very clear right from the first day of this exercise that the work must not pass *any verdict* or frame opinions, rather it should only provide facts extracted from the *primary source*. The verdict and opinion-making should be left to the *readers* based on the facts given.

I decided to ensure nothing except *primary sources* are used to tell the tale of the second Tīmūrid wave[23] (Babur onwards). Accordingly, the narrative concerning Babur in this book is entirely based on the Persian manuscript of the *Baburnama*[24] and wherever confusion prevailed, the existing translated version by Annette Susannah Beveridge[25] has been referred to. Elsewhere, the respective sources referred to are mentioned in the bibliography. At the same time, the historical narratives have been supported with appropriate footnotes and endnotes, and appendices have been duly acknowledged with references.

This volume comprises a two-part narrative. While one part primarily focuses on Babur's journey for the first thirteen–fourteen years of his life post the demise of his father thereby setting the premise very right as to why he wanted to invade Hindustan, the second part deals with a brief analysis of sour situations created by the Tīmūrids (especially economy). These will be dealt with in detail in respective volumes dedicated to the biography of various *Padishah*s. Often claims are made that Babur came and he, along with his successors, became Hindustani. Is this true? Although this volume doesn't answer this question, the next volume would set the case in the right perspective by citing Babur's writings.

In my observation, the subject of history has always been a casualty of biases, which come from different ends of extremities. Things about history need to be read in conjunction with context and time. You can only read about 'historical instances' but never learn 'history' if the 'context' goes ignored. The context creates perspectives through the region of the milieu and the witnesses.

In the case of Tīmūrids (distorted as Moghūls) too, we have more opinions and fewer facts on the mainstream table though they exist in abundance. We have seen extreme fantastical vilification by people like James Todd, while there is extreme eulogizing by others. There are many promoting the Tīmūrids (in the name of Moghūls) for good. But if I look at the records of Tīmūrids themselves, it seems that had anyone of them been alive, they would have